

Six String Sidekick

User Manual

Version 0.2.0 · Build 26
macOS & iPhone

A friendly reference for guitar and bass
Includes Chord Progression Builder, the Guitar / Bass switch, tuner, and offline Help

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Contents

Start with a tool's purpose, follow the steps, then use its tips and troubleshooting. In the app, Help opens the relevant topic; search Help to find another.

> This manual replaces the earlier Quick Start Guide. It describes the working tools in build 26, including Chord Progression Builder and the Guitar / Bass switch. The Mac app runs on macOS 14+; Lyric Ideas needs newer software and Apple Intelligence. See its own section.

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Illustrations are non-interactive renders of the actual SwiftUI views. Some are cropped to show tool content; app chrome and phone layouts can differ. No user songs or copyrighted lyric excerpts are needed for these examples.

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REFERENCE / 01

Install & first launch

Get Six String Sidekick onto your Mac and open the test build safely.

Step by step

1. Use macOS 14 Sonoma or newer. The Mac package supports Apple Silicon and Intel. Lyric Ideas has additional requirements; other tools do not require Apple Intelligence.
2. Open the Six String Sidekick disk image (.dmg). Drag Six String Sidekick onto the Applications folder, wait for the copy to finish, then eject the disk image.
3. Open the app from Applications, not from the mounted disk image. If macOS blocks this ad-hoc-signed, non-notarized test app, dismiss the warning and open System Settings → Privacy & Security.
4. In the Security section, choose Open Anyway for Six String Sidekick, confirm, and open it again. On macOS 14, Control-click → Open may also be available.
5. On first use of Capodastre la Capo, select your guitar tuning and choose Start. You can change tuning later.
6. Coming from Guitar Tool Bro? Install Six String Sidekick manually once. It uses a new app identity and starts with an empty song list and fresh settings; old Guitar Tool Bro data is not migrated or deleted. Remove the old app icon only after the new app works.

Tips

> - The shared iCloud folder may still be named Guitar Tool Bro. That folder name does not change the app name.
> - Only install a package from a source you trust. Open Anyway is not a substitute for checking where a download came from.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Why does macOS warn me? This tester build is not notarized by Apple. The update archives are separately authenticated by Sparkle signatures.

Do I install the Mac DMG on iPhone? No. The iOS target is a separate app build; a Mac disk image is not an iPhone installer.

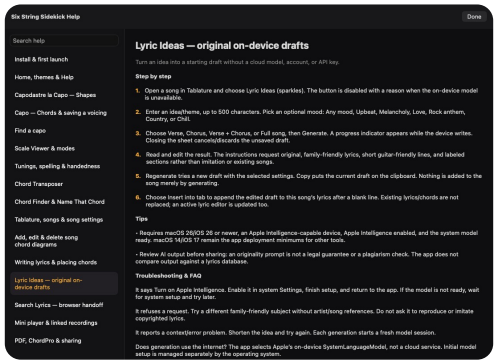
Will later Six String Sidekick updates erase my songs? Replacing the app normally leaves its own saved songs/settings outside the app bundle. Keep a backup before making major changes.

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REFERENCE / 02

Home, themes & Help

Choose a tool, make the screen comfortable, and find help without going online.



Searchable offline Help with a context-selected topic.

Step by step

1. Home has six live tiles: Tuner, Capodastre la Capo, Chord Transposer, Chord Names / Chord Finder, Chord Progression Builder, and Tablature.
2. Choose Guitar or Bass on Home, or from the instrument control in the top bar. On Mac, the Instrument menu has the same choice. Bass can be 4, 5, or 6 strings. The app remembers the choice and starts on Guitar, so existing songs and diagrams are unchanged until you switch.
3. Click or tap a tile to open it. The Home command or house control returns you to the tool chooser where available. On Mac, Shift-Command-H returns Home.
4. Use the paint-palette button on Home to choose Amber Stage, Midnight Blue, Evergreen, Ultraviolet, or Rosewood. The app remembers your selection.
5. Choose Help in the top app strip. From a tool it opens that tool's topic. The song sheet and chord editor also offer their own context Help controls.
6. In Help, browse topics or search terms such as capo, PDF, lyrics, tuning, or loop. Select a result to read its steps, tips, and troubleshooting.
7. On Mac, use Help → Six String Sidekick Help. On iPhone, the small info button on Home opens About; the Help control opens the separate Help center.

Tips

- Help text is bundled and works offline. The full PDF manual is distributed separately to keep the app small.
- Hover over controls on Mac for short hints. VoiceOver reads accessibility hints; some iPhone buttons also explain themselves in a long-press menu.
- Switching to Bass changes the tuner, neck, chord positions, and tab lines. It does not rewrite songs you already saved.
- Chord Progression Builder follows the Guitar / Bass switch: guitar diagrams on Guitar, root/fifth/octave positions on Bass.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Where is the logo? The Home screen intentionally has no logo plate. The BYDS logo is in About.

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Where are the Scales and Chord Chart / Song Sheet Writer tiles? Those standalone tools are not exposed. The working scale viewer is inside Capodastre la Capo → Shapes.

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REFERENCE / 03

Guitar or Bass

One switch tells the tuner, neck, chords, and tab whether you are playing guitar or bass.

Step by step

1. On Home, use the Guitar / Bass control under the welcome banner. The same choice is in the top bar on every screen. On Mac, open the Instrument menu.
2. Guitar is the default. Leave it there and every tool behaves as it did before this switch existed.
3. Choose Bass, then 4-string, 5-string, or 6-string. 4-string standard is E A D G. 5-string adds a low B. 6-string adds a high C. Drop D and a few other common bass tunings are in the tuning picker.
4. The tuner, capo neck, scale overlay, chord finder, new chord diagrams, and the tab staff follow that choice. Chord Transposer still only moves chord symbols.
5. The choice is remembered the next time you open the app. Each instrument keeps its own saved tuning.
6. Songs you already saved still load. Their stored tuning and chord diagrams are not rewritten when you flip the switch.

Tips

> - Use the top-bar control when you are already inside a tool and do not want to go Home first.
> - A 5-string bass low B is about 31 Hz. The tuner’s pitch window is built to reach that note.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

I switched to Bass but an old song still shows a guitar shape. That is expected. Open the song’s tuning if you want that song itself in a bass tuning; the app does not convert saved diagrams automatically.

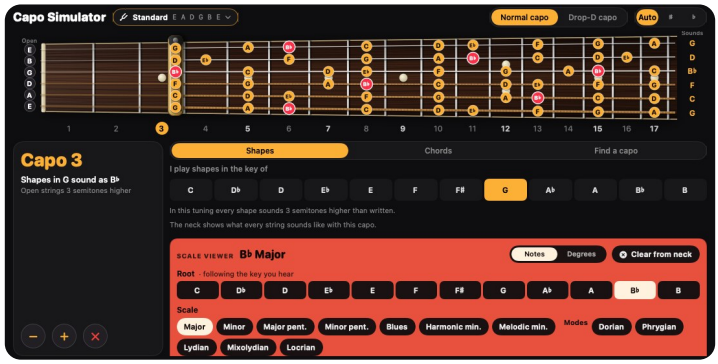
The neck still has six strings. Confirm Bass is selected and check the 4 / 5 / 6 control. Guitar is always six strings.

Did my capo or transpose chart break? The capo still moves clamped strings, and Chord Transposer is instrument-independent. Guitar open-shape capo suggestions are hidden on Bass because those grips are not bass positions.

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Capodastre la Capo — Shapes

See how a capo changes sounding pitches and lets familiar shapes work in new keys.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open Capodastre la Capo. Check the tuning chip first; all note and chord calculations depend on it.
2. Choose Normal capo or Drop-D capo. Normal clamps all strings. The partial Drop-D capo leaves the low string open; it is different from changing the guitar to Drop D tuning.
3. Tap a fret or drag the capo along the neck. Use the capo status controls to move one fret at a time or remove it.
4. Choose Shapes to see the sounding key information and shape controls. Read both the open-string and sounding labels rather than assuming a familiar shape keeps its old pitch.
5. Use the handedness control when needed and choose Auto, sharps, or flats for note spelling. Finger labels and chord voicings can be shown on the neck.
6. Use the Scale Viewer below Shapes to overlay a scale; Clear from neck brings the normal chord display back.

Tips

> - A capo moves clamped strings up in semitones. A shape name and its sounding chord name may differ.
> - On a small iPhone screen, rotate or scroll to reach the controls beneath the fretboard. The Mac workspace can also show a saved-song panel.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

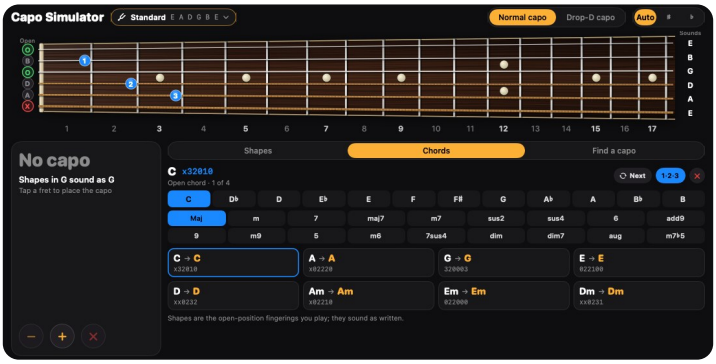
The note names look wrong. Confirm both the actual guitar tuning and whether the selected capo clamps the low string.

Why did chord dots disappear? A scale overlay takes the fretboard display. Choose Clear from neck to return to chord dots.

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Capo — Chords & saving a voicing

Browse chord shapes that account for the selected tuning and capo.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. In Capodastre la Capo, open the Chords tab.
2. Choose the chord you want and inspect its diagram. Change the voicing when alternate fingerings are available.
3. Read X as muted, O as open, dots as fretted notes, and the finger row as suggested fingers. A number beside a higher-position diagram indicates its starting fret.
4. Keep tuning and capo settings consistent with your guitar. The saved voicing includes that setup.
5. Use Add to song when offered, choose an existing song or create one, and confirm. The chord is added to that song’s palette, not automatically to every lyric line.
6. Open the song sheet to use its saved chord symbols in the lyrics. In Tablature you can edit a saved diagram by clicking it.

Tips

- Finger suggestions are aids, not rules: choose a comfortable playable voicing.
- Saving a palette chord and placing its name in a lyric line are separate steps.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

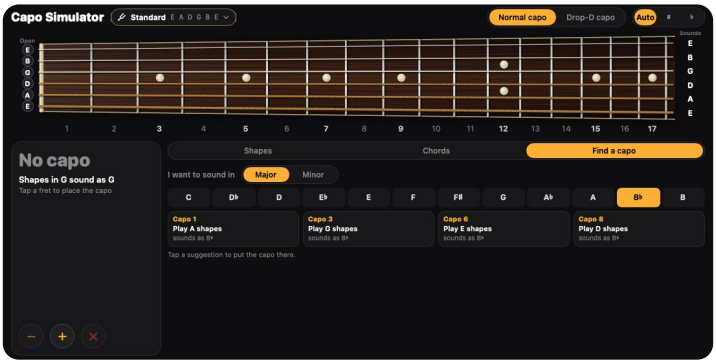
I saved a chord but cannot see it above a word. Insert its bracketed symbol into the lyrics, such as [C]home.

The same chord sounds different with a capo. Read the sounding name and capo note; the diagram is a fingering, not a promise that the open-shape name is the sounding key.

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Find a capo

Find convenient open-shape suggestions for a target key.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open Capodastre la Capo → Find a capo.
2. Choose the target key and major/minor setting offered by the controls.
3. Confirm the tuning and capo type. The suggestion calculation uses both.
4. Read each suggestion’s capo position and shape key. Try the suggested placement on your guitar and compare the sounding key.
5. Return to Shapes or Chords to explore the chosen setup further.

Tips

> - Suggestions are useful starting points, not a full arrangement of every chord in a song.
> - If a song already has a capo, decide whether its written chords are shapes or sounding chords before transposing it again.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

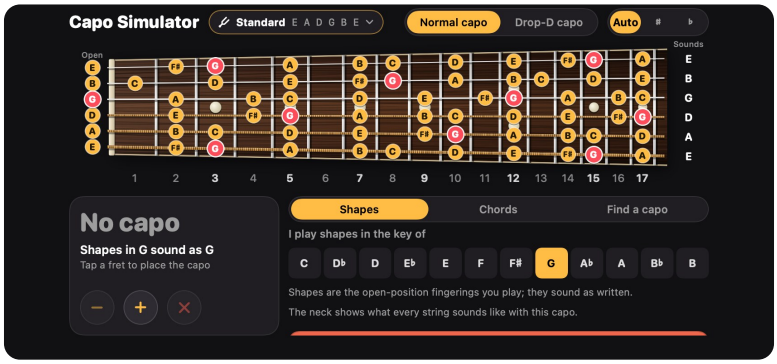
Why are suggestions unexpected? A partial capo or alternate tuning changes the open-string relationships. Recheck both.

Is this automatic pitch detection? No. You choose the target key; the app does not listen to identify a recording’s key here.

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Scale Viewer & modes

Learn note locations, degrees, and intervals inside the Capo Shapes tab.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open Capodastre la Capo → Shapes and find the Scale Viewer beneath the neck.
2. Choose a root and scale type. Available types include Major, Natural minor, Major/Minor pentatonic, Blues, Harmonic minor, Melodic minor, Dorian, Phrygian, Lydian, Mixolydian, and Locrian.
3. Read the notes, scale degrees, interval information, and whole/half-step pattern.
4. Switch Notes / Degrees to change the labels drawn on the scale dots.
5. Choose Show on neck to see sounding scale tones for the current tuning and capo. Roots are distinguished from the other scale tones.
6. Choose Clear from neck to remove the overlay. Changes to tuning/capo change where sounding pitches land.

Tips

> - Start with minor pentatonic or major and compare the note names with degrees.
> - Melodic minor is represented by its ascending form. The viewer is not a microphone tuner or an audio scale detector.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

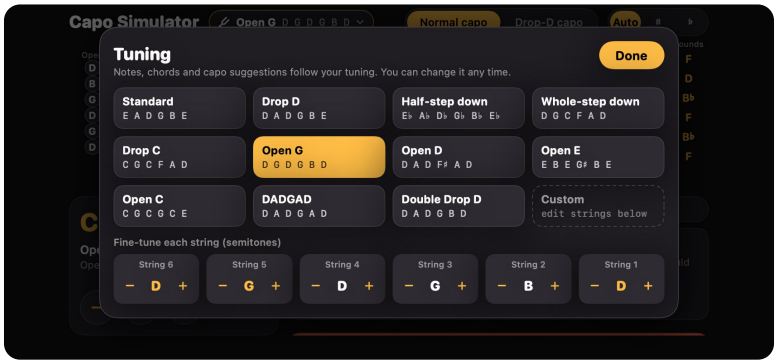
I cannot find a Scales Home tile. The separate scale explorer is hidden; use the working Scale Viewer in Shapes.

Why are there no notes behind the capo? A clamped string begins at the capo; the partial capo may leave the low string open.

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Tunings, spelling & handedness

Match the app’s strings to the guitar or bass you are playing before relying on its diagrams.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. In Capodastre la Capo, click the tuning chip; on Mac Command-T opens the picker while the Capo tool is active.
2. On Guitar, choose a preset: Standard, Drop D, Half step down, Whole step down, Drop C, Open G/D/E/C, DADGAD, or Double Drop D. On Bass, the list is the bass presets for the string count you picked (4-string E A D G, 5-string B E A D G, 6-string B E A D G C, plus drop tunings such as Drop D).
3. For a custom setup, adjust individual strings with the per-string controls. The editor limits each string to an octave above or below standard.
4. Choose Start or Done to close the tuning picker. The Capo tool remembers its saved tuning.
5. Choose Auto, sharps, or flats when available. These change spelling, not pitch: F-sharp and G-flat are the same pitch class.
6. Use the left-handed flip in Capo or Chord Finder when appropriate. Song sheets also have their own tuning setting; check it separately.

Tips

> - The displayed notes are a model of the tuning you enter. Physically tune your guitar with your usual tuner.
> - Changing a global Capo tuning does not mean every previously saved chord or song has been rewritten.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Can the app hear my instrument? Yes. Open the Tuner tile. It listens with the microphone and follows the Guitar or Bass tuning you selected, including a low B around 31 Hz on a 5-string bass.

Drop D tuning or Drop-D capo? Drop D changes the low string’s tuning; the partial capo changes which strings are clamped. They are separate settings.

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Tuner

Listen to a guitar or bass and see the note, how many cents you are off, and which open string is closest.

Step by step

1. Open the Tuner tile on Home.
2. Check the instrument in the top bar. Guitar uses guitar tunings. Bass uses the bass tuning for 4, 5, or 6 strings, with 4-string E A D G as the usual starting point.
3. Choose Listen and allow the microphone if the system asks. Audio is used on this device to detect pitch; it is not uploaded.
4. Play one open string. Read the note name, the frequency, and the cents meter. Green near the center means you are close. The open-string row highlights the closest string in the current tuning.
5. Pick another preset (Standard, Drop D, and the other tunings for that instrument) if you are not in standard. Stop listening when you are done; leaving the Tuner also stops the microphone.

Tips

> - Tune the physical instrument, then set the same tuning in Capodastre la Capo so the neck agrees with what you hear.
> - A 5-string or 6-string bass low B sits near 31 Hz. Give the string a full, steady tone so the detector can lock onto that low fundamental.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Listen does nothing. Allow microphone access for Six String Sidekick in system settings, then try again. A missing input device shows a short message instead of a note.

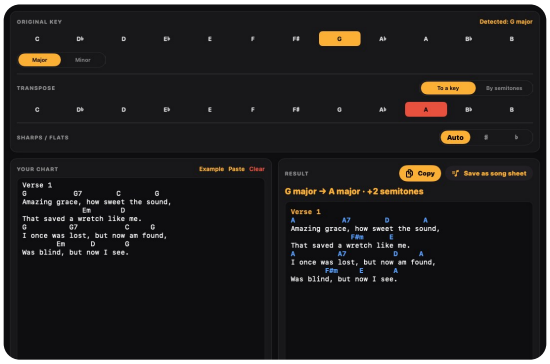
The note is an octave off or jumps around. Play one string at a time, closer to the pickup or sound hole, and quieter than a noisy room. The tuner names pitch; it does not identify chords.

Bass still shows guitar strings such as B E. Switch the instrument to Bass and the string count you actually play. The highlighted open string follows that tuning.

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Chord Transposer

Move a chart to a more comfortable key while keeping its words in place.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open Chord Transposer and paste or type a chart. Supported forms include chords over lyrics, ChordPro-style inline [C] chords, or a plain chord list.
2. Review the detected original key. If it is not the intended key, use the original-key override.
3. Choose To a key and a destination, or choose By semitones and adjust the shift. The result pane updates as the settings change.
4. Choose Auto, sharps, or flats to control chord spelling. Read the result before using it; a pasted chart can contain ambiguous symbols.
5. Use Capo Suggestions when they are available. Selecting a capo representation is different from simply moving the sounding key.
6. Copy Transposed Chart to reuse the result, or Save as Song Sheet to create a song for further editing.

Tips

> - Keep an unmodified copy of a chart while experimenting.
> - Bracketed chord symbols make their role unambiguous: [Am]these words have a chord change.
> - Transposition moves chord symbols. It is the same for guitar and bass and does not change how many strings the neck draws.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

The detected key is wrong. Key detection is a suggestion, especially for short charts. Set the original key yourself.

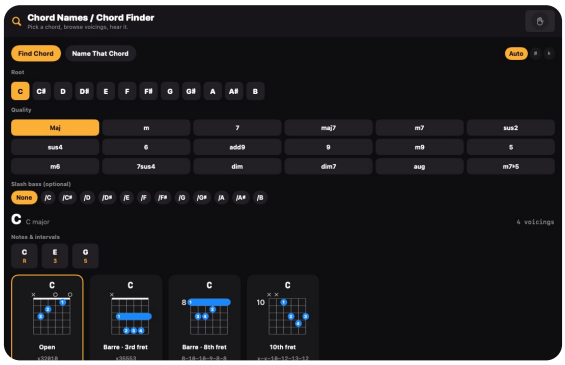
A word was treated as a chord. Review ambiguous chord-only lines, or use ChordPro brackets around actual chord changes.

How do I reset? Choose Back to the Original Key in the Transposer menu, or return the shift to zero.

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Chord Finder & Name That Chord

Find guitar voicings by name, or bass root, fifth, octave, and arpeggio positions. Name a shape you build on the fretboard.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open Chord Names / Chord Finder. In Find Chord, choose a root, quality, and optional slash-bass note.
2. With Bass selected, Find Chord shows bass positions (root, root and fifth, octave, and an arpeggio) on the current string count instead of six-string guitar grips.
3. Browse the voicing cards up the neck. Select a card and use its play control to hear the notes. Strum and arpeggio controls play chord tones differently where offered.
4. Use the left-handed control or spelling chips when needed. These are display choices, not new audio recordings.
5. Switch to Name That Chord. Tap a string/fret to add a note; tap the same position again to clear it. Tap the nut area to switch open/muted.
6. Build all the notes of your shape. Read the best name, alternate names, and interval information. Play the shape or clear the board to start over.
7. For song palettes, use the Find Chord/library picker offered from the song's chord diagram editor or the Capo Chords Add to song flow.

Tips

> - Chord names are interpretations of a set of notes. Different bass notes or omitted tones can lead to several valid names.
> - The standalone Name That Chord board and the song's compact chord diagram editor are separate interfaces.
> - A saved guitar diagram stays six strings when you open the song, even if Bass is selected for new positions.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Why does it show no standard chord? Add more notes or check muted/open strings. You can still label a custom song diagram manually.

Is this listening to my instrument? No. Naming uses the notes you place, not microphone recognition.

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Chord Progression Builder

Pick a key and a style, tap diatonic chords into a progression, and hear or save it.

Step by step

1. Open Chord Progression Builder from Home.
2. Choose one of the 12 keys and Major or Minor. The seven diatonic chords appear with Roman numerals. Tap a numeral to add it. Use the bar stepper, the up/down controls, and remove to edit the line.
3. Choose a style such as Pop, Rock, Blues 12-bar, Country, Jazz ii–V–I, Folk, Ballad, Punk, or Minor / Sad, then Suggest. Pick a pattern such as I–V–vi–IV, I–IV–V, 12-bar blues, ii–V–I, vi–IV–I–V, or i–VI–III–VII.
4. Read the line under the progression for chords that often follow the last one. +1 and −1 transpose the whole progression by a semitone; choosing another key moves it there and keeps the numerals.
5. On Guitar, turn on Show capo shapes to see an easy capo and the open-key shapes to finger. Chord Transposer and the capo tool still do their own jobs; this line is a hint, not a second capo on the neck.
6. Play strums the chords on Guitar and plays each root on Bass, at the tempo you set. Loop repeats until Stop.
7. Copy puts a text chart on the clipboard. Save creates a new song or appends a chord-only line to an existing song, and stores a diagram for each chord. Saved songs are not rewritten when you change Guitar or Bass afterward.

Tips

> - Bars are 1 through 8. A 12-bar blues suggestion already adds up to 12 bars.
> - Jazz suggestions use seventh chords. Other styles use the diatonic triads.
> - Switch to Bass before Play or Save if you want bass positions in the song’s diagrams.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Suggest looks empty for this style? Any style always has patterns, and a style that does not fit the current major/minor mode falls back to patterns for that mode. Minor blues and i–VI–III–VII need Minor.

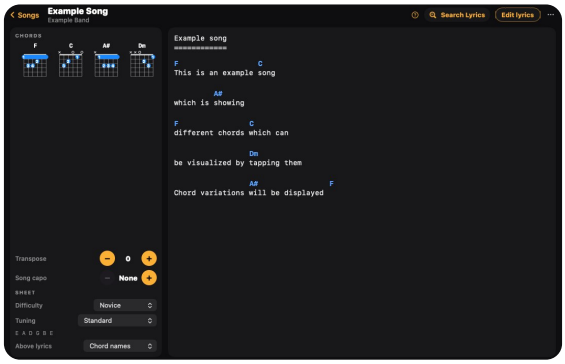
Playback is quiet or only one note? Bass plays the root on purpose. Guitar strums the first Chord Finder voicing. Check the output volume.

The song sheet does not show my old lyrics replaced? Save appends a comment and a chord line. It does not delete lyrics that were already there.

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Tablature, songs & song settings

Create a chord-and-lyric sheet, keep a chord palette, and return to it later.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open Tablature (Writing a Song). Choose New song, enter a title and optional artist, then create it. Existing songs appear in the song list.
2. Open a song. The CHORDS area holds saved diagrams; the other area shows or edits lyrics. Above the list, a tab staff draws one line per string of the current instrument: 6 for guitar, or 4, 5, or 6 for bass, high string on top. The song itself stays a chord-and-lyric sheet. Saved songs still open; switching instrument does not rewrite them.
3. Use the song's more menu to rename/change artist or delete it. Deletion asks for confirmation; keep exports/backups of work you value.
4. Set difficulty, tuning, song capo, and transpose. Transpose changes the displayed chord key; return to zero to see the original symbols.
5. Choose Edit lyrics, enter your text and bracketed chord changes, then Done. Edits are saved locally as you work.
6. Add chord diagrams for the song, or use Lyric Ideas for an original draft. Search Lyrics only opens an external browser search; it does not import lyrics.
7. On Mac, songs can also appear in the Capo workspace's side panel. Show/Hide Song Panel changes that workspace, not your saved song data.

Tips

> - Set title/artist before Search Lyrics so the search is useful.
> - Song capo, song transpose, and the Capo simulator's capo are separate controls; avoid applying the same key change twice.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Do I need a cloud account to save songs? Songs/settings are stored locally. There is no account-based song sync feature in this build.

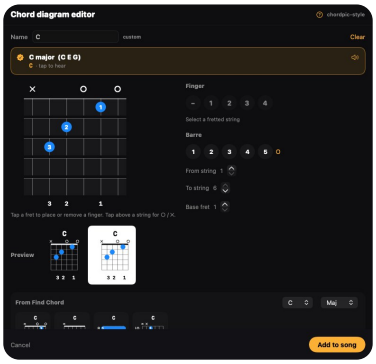
Can I recover a deleted song? There is no promised song recycle bin. Restore an export or your own backup.

Where is the separate Song Sheet Writer tile? It is not exposed; use Tablature for the working writer.

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Add, edit & delete song chord diagrams

Draw a shape for the current instrument and keep its name, fingering, barre, and starting fret together.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. In a Tablature song, choose Add chord diagram. To edit a saved chord, click/tap its existing diagram in CHORDS; the editor opens with that shape filled in.
2. A new diagram uses the current instrument's string count. Opening a chord that was saved on guitar still shows that guitar shape, including six strings.
3. Tap a fret on each string to place one dot per string. Tapping the same spot removes it; tapping another fret on that string moves it. Use the X/O row for mute/open.
4. Watch the live naming callout as you build the shape. It can suggest a name and play the notes. Type a custom name if needed; a manually edited name is not continually overwritten.
5. Set finger numbers, base fret, and barre fret/from-string/to-string controls. Higher-position diagrams use their base-fret setting rather than pretending every shape begins at the nut.
6. Use the Find Chord/library voicing strip to load a known shape as a starting point. Adjust it before saving.
7. Choose Save to add or update the chord in place. Cancel leaves the song unchanged. When a saved chord's name changes, matching song references are updated by the song model.
8. For removal, right-click a saved diagram → Delete, or use Delete in its editor. Confirm the deletion. Review lyric symbols afterward; deleting a palette shape is not a rewrite of your song's words.

Tips

> - X = do not sound that string; O = open string. Finger numbers typically mean 1 index through 4 little finger.
> - The palette shape drives matching inline diagrams and PDF output. Review exports after changing a voicing.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Why is the name different from what I expected? The detector may prefer a different interpretation. Check the sounding notes and bass, or enter your intended name.

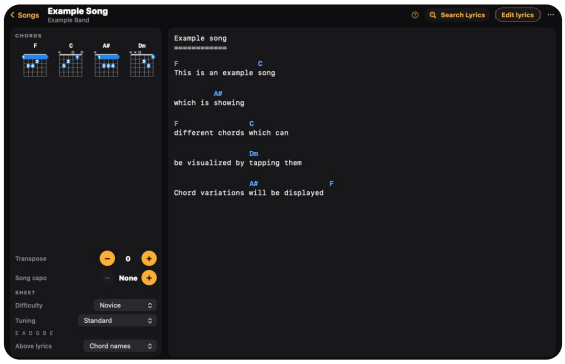
How do I change just one string? Click another fret on that string; the other strings retain their notes.

Why did a chord disappear? Confirm that you saved rather than cancelled, and that it was not deleted from the palette.

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Writing lyrics & placing chords

Keep chords over the correct syllables and choose names or compact diagrams.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open a song and choose Edit lyrics. Type or paste text you have the right to use.
2. Place a chord in brackets immediately before the word or syllable where it changes: [C]Here comes the [G]morning. Saved palette chord chips insert bracketed symbols into the editor.
3. Use section labels such as [Verse 1] and [Chorus], and blank lines to separate musical ideas. Plain lyric lines do not need chord brackets.
4. Choose Done to see the formatted sheet. Chord lines sit close to their lyrics, with a clearer gap between pairs.
5. Use Above lyrics to choose Chord names or Chord diagrams for the song. Select a chord in the rendered sheet for its available per-chord display override.
6. For diagrams, the app uses the matching saved palette shape when available, then a library voicing. Chord-only lines follow the same display choice.
7. Review horizontal placement: chord names follow their word positions; diagrams may shift right to avoid colliding with each other. Use names for very dense changes.

Tips

> - Keep a backup of imported text before major editing. The app saves changes locally while editing.
> - A bracketed musical symbol is a chord; a section heading is a section. Keep chord spellings consistent with your palette.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Can I type six-line numeric guitar tab? You can type plain text, but this build does not provide a dedicated rhythmic/tab-notation editor.

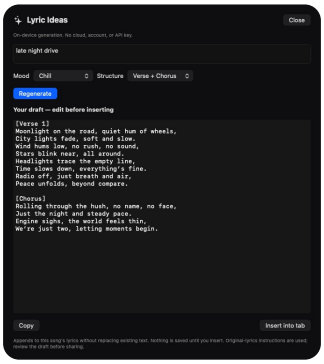
Why is a diagram nudged away from its syllable? Avoiding overlap sometimes takes priority for wide diagrams. Switch to names for a tight chart.

Will transposing rewrite my lyric words? The transpose setting changes displayed chords; the source editor stays in the original key.

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Lyric Ideas — original on-device drafts

Turn an idea into a starting draft without a cloud model, account, or API key.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open a song in Tablature and choose Lyric Ideas (sparkles). The button is disabled with a reason when the on-device model is unavailable.
2. Enter an idea/theme, up to 500 characters. Pick an optional mood: Any mood, Upbeat, Melancholy, Love, Rock anthem, Country, or Chill.
3. Choose Verse, Chorus, Verse + Chorus, or Full song, then Generate. A progress indicator appears while the device writes. Closing the sheet cancels/discards the unsaved draft.
4. Read and edit the result. The instructions request original, family-friendly lyrics, short guitar-friendly lines, and labeled sections rather than imitation or existing songs.
5. Regenerate tries a new draft with the selected settings. Copy puts the current draft on the clipboard. Nothing is added to the song merely by generating.
6. Choose Insert into tab to append the edited draft to this song's lyrics after a blank line. Existing lyrics/chords are not replaced; an active lyric editor is updated too.

Tips

> - Requires macOS 26/iOS 26 or newer, an Apple Intelligence-capable device, Apple Intelligence enabled, and the system model ready. macOS 14/iOS 17 remain the app deployment minimums for other tools.
> - Review AI output before sharing: an originality prompt is not a legal guarantee or a plagiarism check. The app does not compare output against a lyrics database.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

It says Turn on Apple Intelligence. Enable it in system Settings, finish setup, and return to the app. If the model is not ready, wait for system setup and try later.

It refuses a request. Try a different family-friendly subject without artist/song references. Do not ask it to reproduce or imitate copyrighted lyrics.

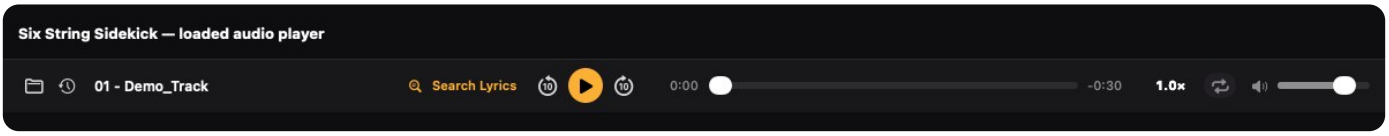
It reports a context/error problem. Shorten the idea and try again. Each generation starts a fresh model session.

Does generation use the internet? The app selects Apple's on-device SystemLanguageModel, not a cloud service. Initial model setup is managed separately by the operating system.

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Search Lyrics — browser handoff

Find a song's lyrics on the web without importing protected lyrics into the app.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. On a song sheet, set the title and optional artist. Choose Search Lyrics beside Edit lyrics; on iPhone it may appear as its search-text icon.
2. For an audio file, load it in the mini player. Search Lyrics appears beside the loaded track title. It is hidden when no track is loaded and disabled if no usable title can be built.
3. The player first uses the audio file's common title/artist tags. Without a tagged title it uses a matching linked song's title/artist; otherwise it cleans the filename by removing the extension, leading track number, and underscores.
4. The app opens the default browser to a URL-encoded Google search for title + artist + lyrics. It does not fetch, scrape, store, or show the search results/lyrics inside the app.
5. Read the results in the browser and respect the source's terms and copyright. Browser search uses the network and may be subject to Google's/browser privacy policies.

Tips

> - Search Lyrics and Lyric Ideas are different: one searches externally for an existing song, while the other generates a new draft on-device.
> - Your browser handles the search. The app does not promise a particular website, lyric match, or license to copy anything.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

The search is for the wrong song. Correct title/artist in the song details or the audio file's tags. A filename can be ambiguous.

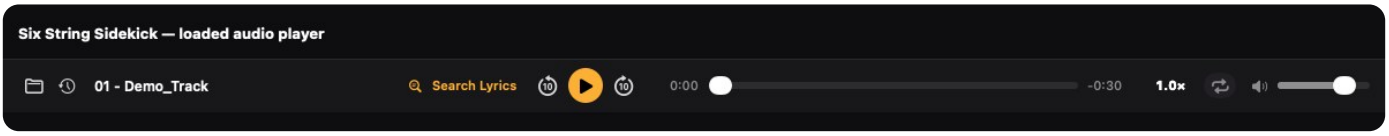
Can it automatically paste lyrics into my sheet? No. Browser handoff deliberately avoids an in-app lyric-fetching/import feature.

Why does an empty song title disable the button? A meaningful title is needed to avoid an unhelpful generic search.

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Mini player & linked recordings

Practice with a local audio file while using the other tools.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. The mini player stays along the bottom of Home and the tools. On Mac choose the folder button, Command-O, or drop a supported audio file onto the bar. On iPhone use Choose from Files.
2. Load MP3, M4A, WAV, or AIFF audio. The title updates from tags when present. Recent files can be reopened from the recents menu; Clear Recent Files clears the list, not the actual recordings.
3. Use Play/Pause, the progress slider, and the 10-second skip controls. On Mac, Space toggles playback unless a text editor/control has keyboard focus.
4. Choose a speed from 0.5× through 1.0× to learn a passage more slowly while preserving pitch. Toggle Loop to repeat the whole track. On Mac the volume slider adjusts the player.
5. In a song's more menu, link the currently loaded recording to the song, play a linked recording, or unlink it. Opening a linked song loads its recording without automatically playing it.
6. Use the player's Search Lyrics action for a browser search based on tags, a linked song, or filename. It does not download lyrics.

Tips

> - Loop repeats the whole track; there is no A/B loop-point editor in this build.
> - Use audio files you are authorized to play. Local playback is not a streaming-service integration or stem-isolation tool.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

It cannot find a recent/linked file. The file may have moved or been deleted, or file access may need granting again. Choose it again and relink if necessary.

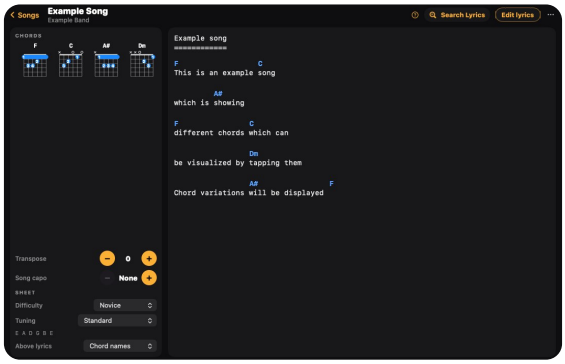
The player cannot open a file. Try a supported, non-DRM audio file. A filename ending in .mp3 is not enough if its contents are not audio.

Why are typed spaces not pausing playback? Space is intentionally left to text editing when a text input/control has focus.

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PDF, ChordPro & sharing

Take a song sheet outside the app and preserve a useful copy.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. Open the song and choose its Share and more menu (ellipsis).
2. Choose Share PDF for a printable chord sheet, Share ChordPro file for bracketed chord/lyric text, or Share as text where offered.
3. Choose a destination in the system share interface. The app does not automatically send the document to anybody.
4. Review the PDF before distributing it: title/artist, difficulty, tuning, key display, capo/transpose, saved chord diagrams, and lyric layout are drawn from the song.
5. The PDF uses US Letter pages with page numbers and app metadata. Chord names/diagrams above lyrics follow the song's setting; long songs can span pages.
6. Keep exports alongside your backups. A PDF is a readable snapshot, not an automatic restoration of all editable song/chord settings.

Tips

> - Check copyright/permission for any lyric text or recording you share.
> - For a dense chart, use chord names rather than diagrams, and review page breaks before printing.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Why does the PDF differ after I edited a chord? Exports are snapshots; export again after changing the palette, lyrics, or settings.

Can I choose paper size or a custom PDF template? This build has a fixed US Letter renderer rather than a full page-design application.

Does the app automatically email my sheet? No; you choose a share destination and take any sending step yourself.

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Updates, About & local data

Keep the app current and understand where your work lives.



SwiftUI view render — controls adapt to screen size.

Step by step

1. On Mac choose Six String Sidekick → Check for Updates…. Follow the update prompt. The app is also configured for daily checks.
2. If a suitable delta is available, Sparkle can download a smaller patch; otherwise it uses the full signed archive. Installation replaces the app bundle, not your saved song folder.
3. If no feed is live or the connection fails, a check can report an unavailable feed. Retry later or use a trusted manual DMG; do not assume every failed check means an update exists.
4. Choose Six String Sidekick → About Six String Sidekick on Mac, or the Home info button on iPhone. About shows the BYDS logo, app name, and version/build.
5. On Mac, current songs are in ~/Library/Application Support/Six String Sidekick/GuitarToolBro-Songs.json. Settings are associated with com.bydougsanders.sixstringsidekick.mac. iOS stores app data in its own sandbox.
6. Back up your work before deleting an app's data or changing machines. Old Guitar Tool Bro used a different identity and folder; Six String Sidekick deliberately does not import that data.

Tips

> - The updater described here is macOS-only. The iOS build does not embed Sparkle.
> - The app has no built-in account sync or backup manager. Distributing installers through iCloud is not the same as syncing song data.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Why are songs empty after the rename? The new identity intentionally starts clean. Old Guitar Tool Bro data remains in its previous location unless you removed it.

Is an update signature the same as notarization? No. EdDSA authenticates the update archive; this test app is still ad-hoc signed and may need Open Anyway on a first manual download.

Can I update while running from a DMG? Install in Applications first, eject the disk image, and open the installed app.

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Keyboard shortcuts & accessibility

Use the Mac menus efficiently without losing text-editing keys.

Step by step

1. Command-N creates a song. Command-O opens audio. Shift-Command-H returns Home.
2. In the Capo tool, Command-[/ Command-] move the capo down/up a fret; Command-0 removes it; Command-T opens tuning.
3. Option-Command-1 / 2 / 3 choose Shapes / Chords / Find a capo. Command-J advances the current chord voicing when available.
4. Command-backslash shows/hides the Capo workspace song panel. Escape returns from the song sheet where that shortcut is active.
5. In Transposer, Option-Command-Up/Down shifts a semitone; Shift-Command-C copies the transposed chart.
6. In playback, Option-Command-Left/Right skips 10 seconds. Space toggles play/pause only when a text field/control is not using the key.
7. Use Help → Six String Sidekick Help for offline topics. VoiceOver labels/hints identify many icon-only actions; hover tips help with mouse use.

Tips

> - Menu commands are context-sensitive and may be disabled outside their tool.
> - On iPhone, use the on-screen controls. Some layouts scroll or move controls above lyrics in portrait orientation.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Why is a shortcut disabled? Open the tool it applies to, load a track, or select a voicing as appropriate.

How can I identify an icon? Hover on Mac, use VoiceOver, or try a supported long-press explanation on iPhone. The searchable Help center gives the longer version.

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Troubleshooting & feature boundaries

A quick checklist when something does not look or sound right.

Step by step

1. If the neck, tuner, or tab has the wrong number of strings, check Guitar or Bass in the top bar or on Home, and the bass string count (4, 5, or 6). Saved songs keep the tuning and diagrams they were stored with.
2. For chord/key problems, check tuning, capo type, capo fret, transpose, and spelling. Distinguish a guitar shape from the chord's sounding name.
3. For an empty lyric sheet, open the correct song, choose Edit lyrics, and confirm that you inserted/generated text rather than just closing an unsaved draft.
4. For audio problems, load a valid local file again, check the output device/volume, and verify that the file has not moved.
5. For Lyric Ideas, read its availability message. It needs Apple Intelligence and a ready on-device model; there is no cloud fallback.
6. For installation/update problems, launch from Applications, follow Privacy & Security → Open Anyway when appropriate, and retry a failed feed check later.
7. Before a risky change, keep exports and a backup of your app data. If reporting a bug, include the version/build from About and a clear description of the action and result.

Tips

> - Not shipped as standalone Home tools: Scales explorer and Chord Chart / Song Sheet Writer. Scale Viewer and Tablature already cover their described working functions.
> - Not present: Track Isolation, microphone chord recognition, multi-track tab sequencing, automatic lyric fetching, cloud lyric generation, account-based song sync, or automatic song-backup recovery. The Tuner listens for pitch only; it does not name chords from the microphone.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

Can Help contact support or upload diagnostics? No. It is bundled reading material; it does not send your songs or logs anywhere.

Does generation guarantee lyrics are unique or cleared for release? No. Review generated material and seek rights advice where needed.

Where is the full manual? Use Six String Sidekick User Manual.pdf in the shared installer folder. It supersedes the older Quick Start Guide.

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